

Is 64-bit Worth It?

Q I recently bought a new system with an AMD Athlon64 3200 processor, ASUS A8N-VM motherboard with integrated graphics (NVIDIA GeForce 6100 256 MB), 512 MB 400 MHz Transcend RAM, and a Seagate Barracuda 80 GB SATA hard disk.

Should I install the regular Windows XP Professional with SP2 or should I go for Windows XP 64-bit? What are the advantages of the latter? I use my system mainly for home applications and gaming.

Ayush Sobti

A While the 64-bit edition of Windows XP has been around for quite some time now, there isn't a suffi-

cient number of applications that use the 64-bit architecture. There are a few, though—for example, The AMD64 version of *Far Cry* is available for the 64-bit version of XP. The AMD64 version is an upgrade that installs on top of the retail boxed version, and AMD claims it “gives you an enhanced *Far Cry* experience.”

Earlier, the non-availability of 64-bit driver support was an issue with the 64-bit operating system, but 64-bit drivers for your system are easily available and can be downloaded from the respective manufacturers' Web sites.

32-bit applications will, of course, run on XP 64-bit, but in 32-bit mode—just as in the 32-bit version of XP. So for the time being at least, there's no point opting for the 64-bit version of XP.

the latest version. Another reason could be that your firewall or proxy server is corrupting PDFs while they download. The solution here is to download the PDF to your hard drive and then view it rather than viewing it in your browser.

TV-Tuner Trouble

Q I use Windows XP Media Center Edition. Recently, I installed a Pinnacle PCTV 50i TV-Tuner card. It works fine with the Pinnacle Media Center software, but whenever I start the Windows XP Media Center TV application, it shows an error: “Your TV card is not compatible with Windows or is not configured properly...” Does this mean that I can't use the TV card with Windows XP Media Center?

Siddhartha Biswas

A We would like to bring to your notice that you can only install and use Windows XP Media Center Edition OS if you had bought a Media Center PC. Windows XP Media Center Edition is not available off the shelf and only comes bundled with Media Center PCs. If you obtained from elsewhere, it is pirated, and we cannot help you.

If you have a Media Center PC and are trying to replace the TV-Tuner with the Pinnacle PCTV 50i, then we must tell you that there are a limited number of TV-Tuners that are compatible with Windows XP Media Center Edition. Your TV-Tuner is not supported by this operating system—hence the error message. You can still use this TV-Tuner with the OS by installing the required drivers and using third-party PVR software as in other flavours of Windows XP, but it does not fulfil the TV-Tuner hardware requirements of this OS—and hence cannot be used with the Windows XP Media Center TV application.

You can find out about TV-Tuners supported by or compatible with Windows XP Media Center Edition from www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/mediacenter/partners/dfw/tvtuner-cardsreq.mspx.

500 Per Cent Indeed!

Q I use Windows XP Pro and IE 6. I have installed Internet Download Accelerator. But the download speeds are more or less the same, when

people say it can increase download speeds up to 500 per cent. I use a 128 kbps connection. What other download accelerators would you recommend? Also, I use Opera 8.5. I can't incorporate any download manager into Opera. What do I do?

Saurabh Sood

A Download managers try to give you the highest download speeds from your Internet connection by splitting the file being downloaded into multiple segments and then downloading the segments simultaneously. The highest download speed you can get is limited by the speed of your Internet connection which in your case is 128 kbps. Then again, the Web site from which you are downloading files also is a factor in the maximum download speed you can get. The 500 per cent claim is almost rubbish; it does say “up to 500 per cent,” which can be as little as 5 or 10 per cent!

A good download manager we can suggest is FlashGet, from www.amazesoft.com. The FlashGet plug-in for Opera can also be downloaded from the same site.

The Registry To The Rescue

Q I own a cyber café. People come and download files, and I want to change the download location of the files to a location of my choice. How do I do this?

Abhishek Yadav

A You can set the download path using the Registry Editor. Browse to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Internet Explorer and find the String “Download Directory” in the right pane. Double-click on this and change it to a valid location of your choice. This is where files will get downloaded the next time someone clicks a download link.

However, this location can be changed if a new location is specified. To prevent the user from doing this, navigate to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Policies\Microsoft\Internet Explorer\Restrictions. If this value is not present, you can create it. In the right pane, create a new DWORD called “NoSelectDownloadDir” and set its value to 1. ■



Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!